

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Q+A

MAN ON A MISSION

Adarsh Gourav on his role in *Kho Gaye Hum Kahan*, his love for music and upcoming projects, including the US show *Alien*

Q. Were you surprised to be cast as a gym instructor in *Kho Gaye Hum Kahan*?
It was a leap of faith for the filmmakers, but they had confidence in my ability to change my physicality. Neil is the closest to what my life has been. When I was 14, I moved from Jamshedpur to Mumbai. It was a big cultural shift. I felt Neil didn't belong to the world he was part of. He was trying to be much more, which I was trying to do too back then.

Q. You've won fans on social media for your musical talent.
One of the reasons I moved to Mumbai was to have a career in music. I started with playback when I was 13.... Initially I was reserved about putting my music out on Instagram.... The love I've received has inspired me to write my own music again.

Q. You soon head to Bangkok to begin shooting for the US show *Alien*. Does such shuttling lead to scheduling conflicts?
I feel I'm living my dream. I want to be working in good cinema irrespective of where it's being made. I don't want to restrict myself.... Of course, there are a lot of scheduling conflicts, but you win some, you lose some.

Q. Netflix recently renewed *Guns & Gulaabs* for season two.
I enjoyed not having any boundaries playing Jugnu. Raj & DK really gave me the freedom. I recently realised he has a mole, which I decided to add because I saw Jugnu as a fan of Rekha and Madhubala. There are a lot of these finer details that you or the director bring in because you enjoy it so much. It's what makes the character or show memorable.

with Suhani Singh